



POLLINATOR-FRIENDLY GARDENING

Support pollinators through the heat and keep bees, butterflies, and beneficial insects thriving all summer.

Why pollinators struggle in summer:

- Fewer fresh blooms = less food
- Heat dries up nectar and shallow water sources
- Overuse of pesticides puts pollinators at risk

You can help—here's how.



Plant for continuous bloom.

Keep flowers coming from midsummer into fall. **Tip:** group plants in clumps for better foraging efficiency.

Top perennials:

- Purple coneflower; *Echinacea purpurea*
- Bee balm; *Monarda fistulosa*
- Blazing star; *Liatris spicata*
- Goldenrod; *Solidago* spp.

Heat loving annuals:

- Zinnia; bright and reliable
- Cosmos; airy, colorful, low-maintenance
- Mexican sunflower; *Tithonia* – butterfly favorite

Herbs that do double-duty:

- Basil, thyme, oregano, and dill attract bees and beneficial wasps when left to flower.



Create a pollinator water station.

No standing water = no mosquito problems.

- Fill a shallow dish, saucer, or birdbath with clean water.
- Add pebbles or flat stones for safe landing spots.
- Place in part shade and refresh daily.

Summer pollinator tips:

- Water blooming plants early to preserve nectar.
- Leave some herbs and vegetables to flower.
- Skip pesticides in favor of *pollinator-safe*, organic treatments.
- Provide shade with shrubs or tall perennials for mid-day rest spots.

Homestead picks for pollinator support:

- Native plants for full-season color
- Pollinator Seed Mixes for sunny beds and containers
- Espoma® Organic Fertilizers – bee and bird-safe
- Bee houses and butterfly feeders
- Zinnia, Cosmos, dill, and coneflower starts; heat-ready blooms

Grow pollinator-friendly all summer.

Check our events calendar for pollinator gardening workshops!

Visit Homestead Gardens for plants, water features, and natural care solutions in-store or online: homesteadgardens.com.

